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ASUS VG278QR

Sub-1 ms response times are here

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he VG278QR is the first 0.5ms response time gaming monitor that we've

received this year, but before we get into the details, it would be wise to note that the minimum possible response time is 0.5ms whereas the average response time is 1ms (gray-to-gray). Also, while the box does not mention it, this monitor is "G-Sync Compatible" which means that NVIDIA will make the G-sync option available in the driver control centre once you have this connected. Let's see how the ASUS VG278QR fares in our review.



Build & Features

Aesthetically, you could place the VG278QR mid-way on the spectrum of ASUS monitors. From the front you have a fairly simplistic appearance with the bezels being slightly thicker than competing gaming monitors. We see a sturdy base and an equally rigid stem with a cutout for cable management. The VG278QR has an adjustable height which can be varied by 130 mm and the display can be rotated by 90 degrees in either direction. As for the tilt, we have 33 degrees towards the user and 5 degrees away from the user.

On the rear, there isn't any of the fancy RGB lighting that is commonly seen on the ROG monitors. The 2 Watt RMS speakers are fairly loud but they can, by no means, replace a dedicated set of 2.1 desktop speakers but it gets the job done. Coming to the I/O, we have HDMI, DP 1.2, 3.5mm audio output and DVI-D Dual Link connectors and an external power adapter. The control panel has one joystick and four tactile buttons. We are certainly cognizant of the convenience of a joystick, but we don't like the fact that they have



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a tendency of breaking often if not properly implemented.

Coming to the panel itself, the VG278QR uses a TN panel illuminated by a WLED backlight that's common for most high refresh-rate monitors in the market. It's an 8 bit (6+FRC) panel, so there's no HDR. The screen-to-body ratio is approximately 90% owing to the slightly thicker bezels and the panel comes with an anti-glare coating on it. The OSD on the VG278QR features 8 modes which feature presets, blue light filter, colour, image, sound, source selection, system settings and a favourites tab. You do get to set the individual Red, Green and Blue values.

Performance

Starting off with the colour gamut, the VG278QR measured in at 72% NTSC, which is within spec. While calibrating the colour, we had to reduce the red value by 1 and the blue by 2. In our colour reproduction test, the maximum Delta E among all colour patches tested was 12.01 and the average Delta E for all patches was 1.37. This makes it a really

good TN panel in our books. There was barely any backlight bleeding and at maximum brightness, this one is a scorcher. We clocked it at 370 nits which is quite ridiculous. The contrast ratio was measured to be about 910:1 which is very close to spec as well. It's not the highest we've seen from ASUS. Some of the ROG Swift PG-series panels clock in at much higher.

Coming to brightness uniformity, we measured an average Delta E of 1.45 which means the panel is very uniformly lit. Post calibration, the average power draw was about 28 Watts and we didn't experience any localised hot spots as is common with G-sync monitors. This being a G-sync compatible monitor, there is no NVIDIA module which is often the culprit when it comes to heating issues. Lastly, we ran the frame skipping test at 165 Hz and found no issues at all. Since this is a TN-panel, there is the obvious issue with poor viewing angles so that's there. Overall, we have a very good panel on the VG278QR that's as colour accurate as a TN panel can be and brighter than most in the segment.

Verdict

With the high refresh-rate monitor segment gaining traction, manufacturers are having to aggressively deliver more features at a competitive price point. The ASUS VG278QR sits right in the sweet spot between 144-165 Hz and has a really bright panel with good colour reproduction. There's also the value addition in the form of the OSD assists for gamers that's slowly becoming the norm in this price segment. Overall, the VG278QR with its 0.5 ms response time is positioned as a worthy competitor in this segment.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

PANEL: TN | SCREEN SIZE: 27-inches | RESOLUTION: 1920 X 1080 | REFRESH RATE: 165HZ | CONNECTORS: DVI-D DL, 1x HDMI 1.4, 1x DP 1.2 | AUDIO PASSTHROUGH: Yes | CONTRAST RATIO: 1000:1

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